The Well-Tempered clAIvier

Fugue XV in G major, four voices: Fuga a 4 sopra 'Vom Himmel hoch'

Keyboard - four voices

Claude / Sam (on Luther's chorale, 1539; after Bach's Canonic Variations BWV 769)

I. Soprano: line 1, subject 1

Moderato, con allegrezza (♩ = 76)

S1: subject (line 1 diminished), soprano

Soprano

Alto

S1: answer in D, alto

Tenor

Bass

5

S

A

S1: subject, tenor

T

S1: answer in D, bass

B

line 1 (soprano)

9

L1: chorale line 1 (cantus), soprano

S1 in D (stretto), alto
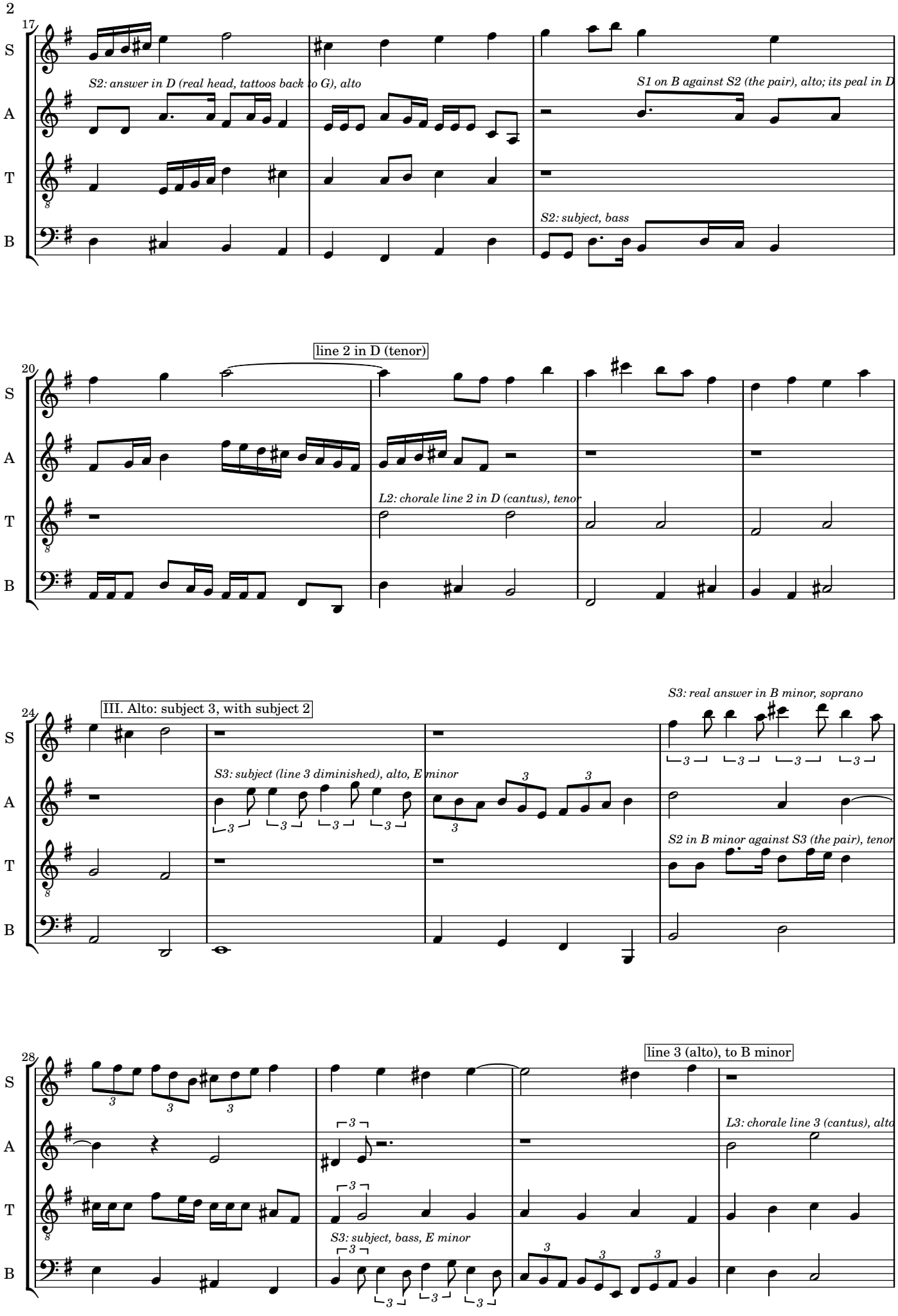
S1 in C (stretto), tenor
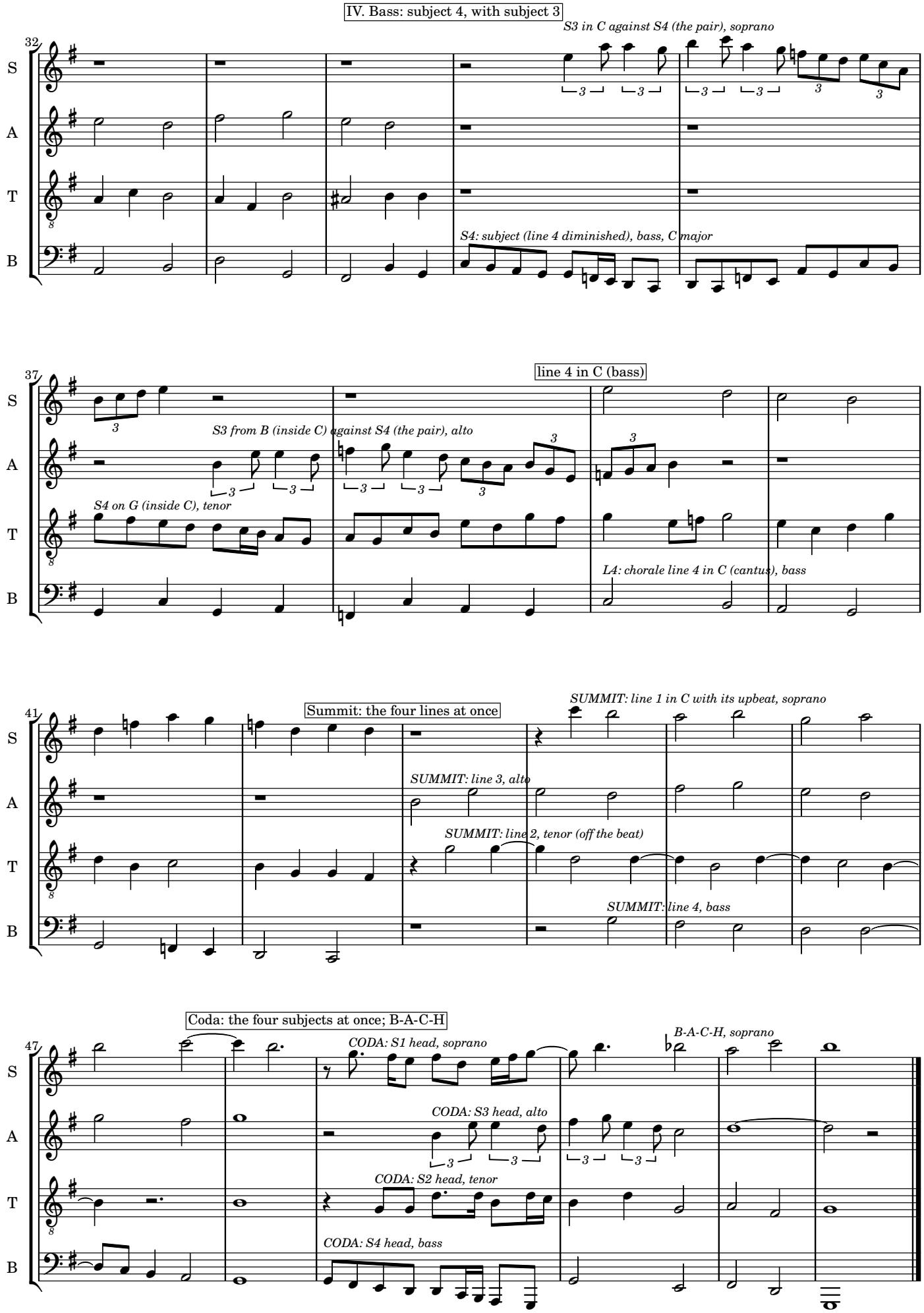
II. Tenor: subject 2, with subject 1

13

S1 on B against S2 (the pair), soprano

S2: subject (line 2 diminished), tenor


17
S
A
T
B
S2: answer in D (real head, tattoos back to G), alto
S1 on B against S2 (the pair), alto; its peal in D
S2: subject, bass
20
line 2 in D (tenor)
L2: chorale line 2 in D (cantus), tenor
24
III. Alto: subject 3, with subject 2
S3: real answer in B minor, soprano
S3: subject (line 3 diminished), alto, E minor
S2 in B minor against S3 (the pair), tenor
28
line 3 (alto), to B minor
L3: chorale line 3 (cantus), alto
S3: subject, bass, E minor


IV. Bass: subject 4, with subject 3
S3 in C against S4 (the pair), soprano
S4: subject (line 4 diminished), bass, C major
line 4 in C (bass)
S3 from B (inside C) against S4 (the pair), alto
S4 on G (inside C), tenor
L4: chorale line 4 in C (cantus), bass
Summit: the four lines at once
SUMMIT: line 1 in C with its upbeat, soprano
SUMMIT: line 3, alto
SUMMIT: line 2, tenor (off the beat)
SUMMIT: line 4, bass
Coda: the four subjects at once; B-A-C-H
CODA: S1 head, soprano
B-A-C-H, soprano
CODA: S3 head, alto
CODA: S2 head, tenor
CODA: S4 head, bass